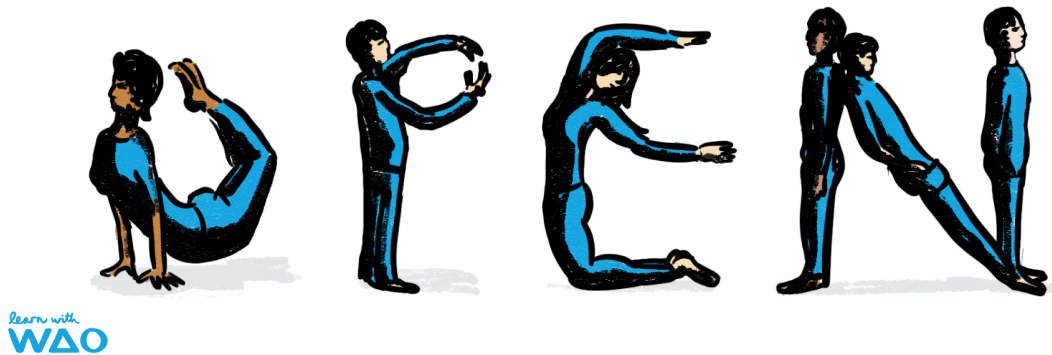


Rationale: this is an update to the [v0.1](#) we put out in summer 2020, which was bashed out in an afternoon by Doug and Laura, and illustrated magnificently by Bryan. It's (hopefully!) a little more polished and informative...

what we talk about

WHEN WE TALK ABOUT



(v0.5)

Openness is people. It's an attitude. It's how people are with each other. And there's some tech stuff too.

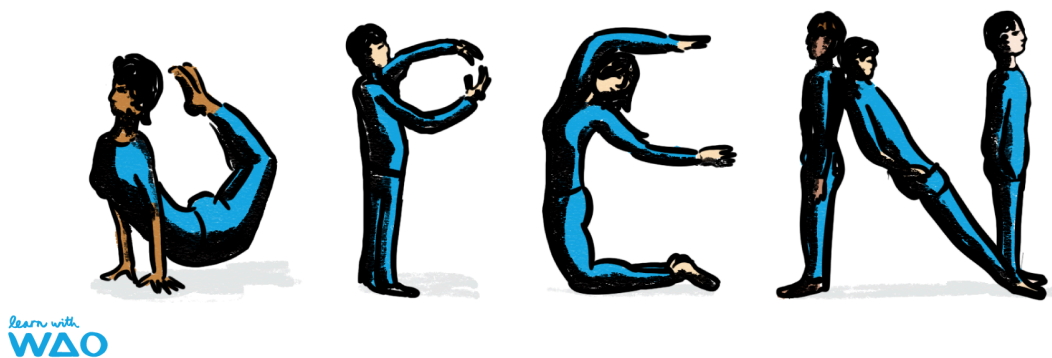
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-

1. Introduction

Email subject: 🔒 Introduction: What We Talk About When We Talk About Open

what we talk about
WHEN WE TALK ABOUT



👋 Hello!

Welcome to *What We Talk About When We Talk About Open*, an introductory course from [We Are Open Co-op](#)! We're aiming this at helping organisations harness the three main benefits of open: **greater agility**, **faster innovation**, and **increased engagement**.

These emails are going out every other day, meaning the course will cover a two-week period. If someone has forwarded this to you, then consider signing up for yourself [here](#).



OPEN IS AN ATTITUDE

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But what exactly is openness? After all, we use the word 'open' in different ways - for example, talking of a door or a window being 'open', or having an 'open' position in an organisation.

In fact, there are many, *many* different types of definitions of open, as some academics pointed a few years ago in a very readable article entitled [Fifty shades of open](#). Here's a few uses they spotted:

- Open means rights
- Open means access
- Open means use
- Open means transparent
- Open means participatory
- Open means enabling openness
- Open means philosophically aligned with open principles

It's not even that there's lots of definitions of openness, it's that it's a contested term. Everyone wants to be seen as 'open' rather than 'closed', so there's vested interests in defining the term. And yes, sadly, "[open washing](#)" is *a thing*.

So, for the avoidance of doubt, and because in this course we're talking about openness in the context of organisations, we're going to use the phrase **Open is an Attitude** as a shorthand for [The Open Organization Definition](#), which some of the members of our co-op helped write.

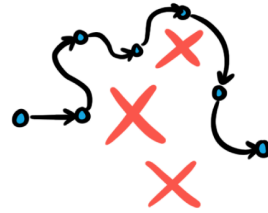
The definition outlines five key characteristics of an 'open' organisation or project:



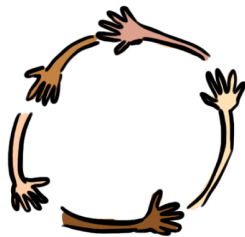
TRANSPARENCY



INCLUSIVITY



ADAPTABILITY



COLLABORATION



COMMUNITY

In this course, then, we'll be sharing tactics to help your organisation learn and embody these characteristics. Be aware, though, that this is an *introductory* course so we'll be signposting you to places where you can find out more when you're ready to take your open journey further!

At the bottom of each email we're going to give you some tasks to complete which, we hope, will help deepen your understanding and knowledge of openness and why it's so valuable. The first one is below, so take a look!

OK, let's start things off on a practical note. So that we've got a baseline, take a look at the [Open Organization Maturity Model](#) and consider where it stands *right now*.

Here's what to do:

1. [Click here](#) and navigate to 'Register' at the top-right of the page
2. Complete the survey
3. Take a screenshot of your results ([how?](#))

If you are taking this email course with others in your organization (*what a great idea!*), then ask them to put their screenshots in with yours. You could use Google Drive, Dropbox, Nextcloud, or some other service to do this.

Completing this activity in a collaborative way allows you to compare and contrast with your colleagues where you think your organisation currently stands. That could lead to a conversation based on the following:

- How open is your organisation?
- Were you surprised by the results?
- Which of the five principles needs most work in your organisation?

Remember, openness is not like a lightswitch, it's a *continuum*, not a binary. It's also rather contagious – openness begets openness! 😊

Next up: we'll be looking at examples of openness in practice, from NGOs to the Japanese government, to companies such as Google!

Could your organisation do with more in-depth benchmarking and follow-up workshops? We Are Open runs tailored programmes with organisations of every size. [Get in touch](#) to find out more!



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2. Examples

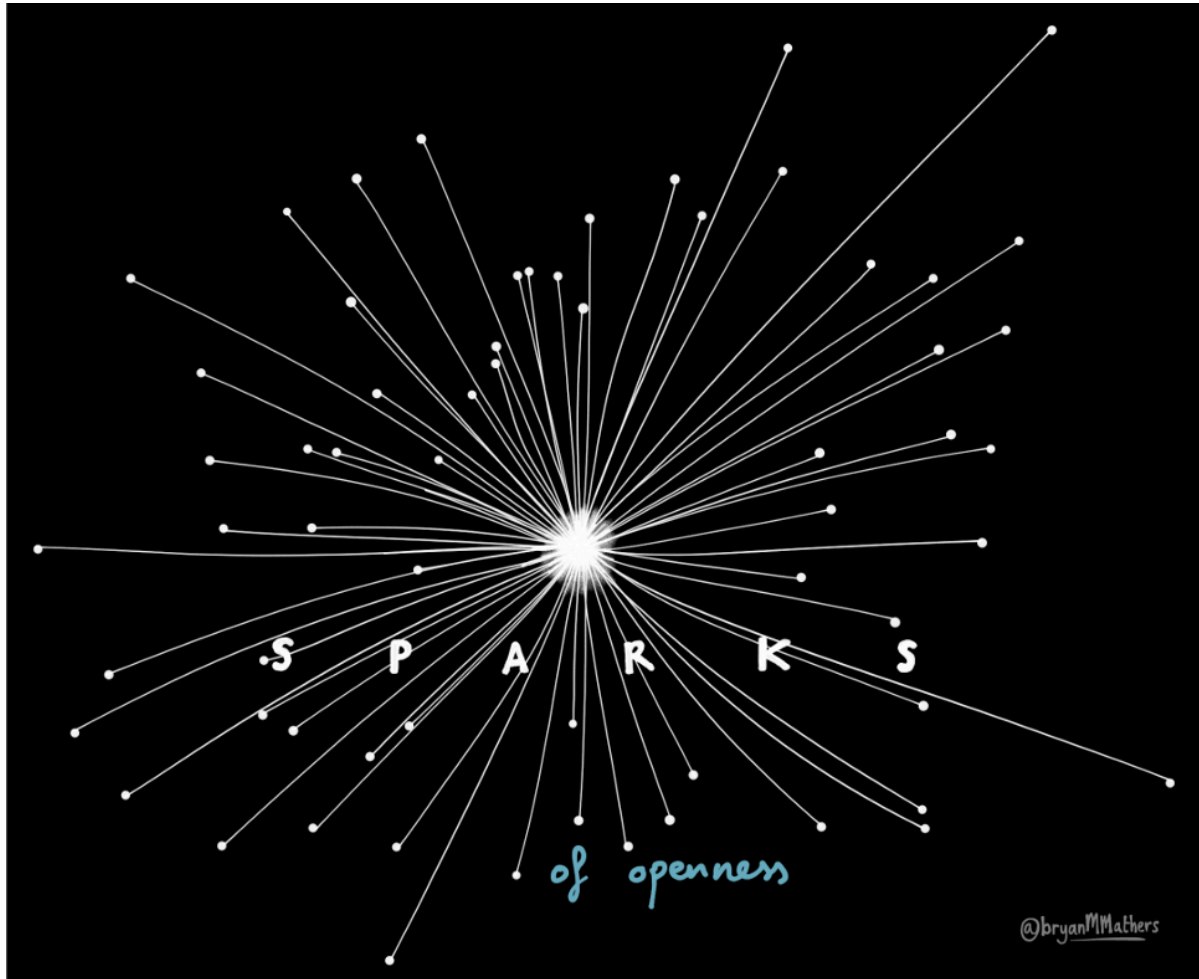
Email subject: 🔒 Examples of openness in practice

👋 Hello again!

Welcome back to *What We Talk About When We Talk About Open*, an email course from We Are Open Co-op. If you've had this email forwarded to you from a friend or colleague, you can sign up for yourself [here](#).

Last time, we looked at some definitions of openness and asked you to rate your organisations using the [Open Organization Maturity Model](#). We'd encourage you to go back and do that, if you haven't already.

0



One of the barriers to working different to 'business as usual' can be that people want *proof* positive that a new approach can work. So while we could try and convince you philosophically that openness is the best way forward for you and your organisation, some case studies and examples might serve us better here.

Governments

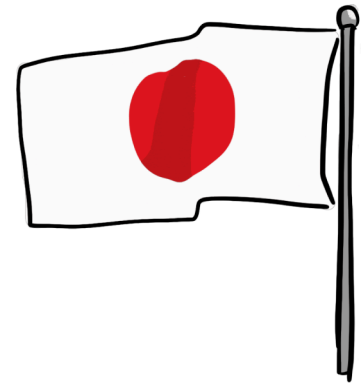
First off, let's consider governments, who exist to represent the interests of the citizens of their country. What a great reason to be open! After all, we all want our representatives to reap the rewards of the three main benefits of openness: **greater agility**, **faster innovation**, and **increased engagement**.

Let's take three examples — Japan, Sweden, and the UK.

Who? Japanese Government

What problem were they trying to solve? Accelerated by the impact of the Great East Japan Earthquake of 2011, which resulted in over 20,000 thousand deaths and massive damage to the country's infrastructure, the Japanese government recognised the need for better coordination of data, to identify where people were, what was needed, who could provide help, resource availability, pollution levels etc.

How did they solve it? By developing the Japan Open Government Strategy, which includes making data from a variety of sources openly available.

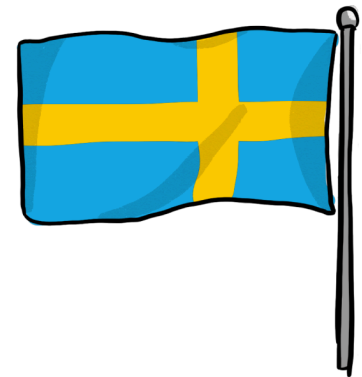


"The purposes of the strategy are to immediately undertake measures for encouraging the use of public data and to implement them broadly in order to raise the standard of living and invigorate business activities, contributing to the development of Japan's society and economy as a whole."

Who? Swedish Government

What problem were they trying to solve? How to improve innovation and enhance the welfare of Swedish citizens.

How did they solve it? Empowering citizen-driven innovation via open collaboration, with Hack for Sweden.



"We are Sweden's new platform for citizen-driven innovation and over 95 Swedish government agencies and companies are already cooperating to promote innovation through open data. As part of the process of increasing the digitalization of our public sector, the Swedish Government put focus on open data and citizen-driven innovation. Public sector, academic sector and enterprises need to interact and collaborate. Through open and citizen-driven innovation, more people than ever can contribute to our welfare and together we can build the society we dream of tomorrow — Sweden 4.0."

Who? UK Government

What problem were they trying to solve? How to identify problems and gaps in provision, and ultimately improve services for citizens.

How did they solve it? Members of the public can suggest a problem found in government, which an open standard might solve or improve, through the GitHub 'open-standards' repository. This is then reviewed by the Open Standard team, which is overseen by the Open Standards Board, which is:



"...a panel of experts drawn from industry, academia and the public sector. The board uses the government's open standards principles and a rigorous selection process to choose standards for use in government. These standards improve the efficiency of government services, data and technology, and the board can decide to either mandate or recommend using them."

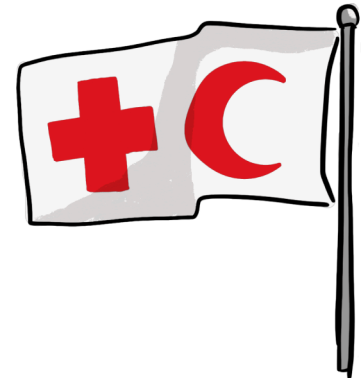
NGOs

Next, let's turn to non-governmental organisations, or NGOs as they're known. This type of organisation needs to be able to raise money, working effectively and efficiently so that they can have an impact in line with their mission. Again, they can benefit from the **greater agility, faster innovation, and increased engagement** that working openly offers! Let's look at a couple of examples...

Who? International Federation of Red Cross (IFRC)

What problem were they trying to solve? How to connect like-minded people and organizations all over Switzerland to develop, scale and celebrate solutions to the Corona crisis.

How did they solve it? Versus Virus Hackathon. Developing a "system of systems".



"We need to grow the mental muscle of collaboration within institutions and communities. With businesses and technologists as partners there remains incredible global reach and potential. It can't just be the 'technical staff' in institutions, we need to prepare our experts to collaborate with new types of partners, individuals, and networks. This is part of becoming an open organization and truly solving globally and locally." (Heather Leson)

Who? Greenpeace International

What problem were they trying to solve? How to empower the community to collectively create and amplify Greenpeace solutions.

How did they solve it? The Greenpeace Planet 4 team has been implementing an open culture. They are using open principles to develop open software to power Greenpeace websites, via open collaboration techniques, and open engagement.



"Open organizations (or networks of organizations such as Greenpeace) explicitly invite participation from external communities, because these networks know their products and programs are world class only if they include a variety of perspectives at all phases of development." (Laura Hilliger)*

Yes, *that* Laura Hilliger - she's been working in-depth with Greenpeace over the last few years, and has even [won an award](#) for helping them move towards more open practices!

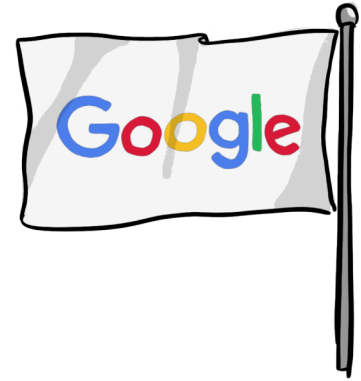
Companies

Finally, let's look at for-profit companies who, of course, absolutely want to ensure that they exhibit **greater agility, faster innovation, and increased engagement!** That's why so many are finding that working openly is a competitive advantage. We could name many other examples here, such as IBM and Microsoft, but let's focus on a name that everyone knows...

Who? Google

What problem were they trying to solve? How to empower high-performance teams and increase productivity.

How did they solve it? [SCARF](#). Wanting to know what interventions led to high-performing teams, [research from Project Aristotle](#) highlighted the importance of collaboration and employee psychological safety. As a result, Google uses the acronym SCARF, which stands for: Status; Certainty; Autonomy; Relationships; Fairness, to promote inclusion and trust when collaborating openly, so people can contribute their best work.



There are even more examples in [this post](#) on the We Are Open blog.

Now that you've got some examples to give you a better flavour of openness in different types of organisations, let's think about how we can *apply* what we've learned this time around.

Here's what to do:

1. Decide which example(s) resonate best with your organisation. Think about what that example of openness would like if translated to your organisation: would it be exactly the same? is your context slightly different meaning it would have to be 'translated' in some ways?
2. Reflect on your thinking openly, either in public on a blog or social media, or within your organisation in a channel that all (or many) can access. What do *other* people think?

If you need a link to reference this particular part of the course, then you can click [here](#).

Next up: we'll be looking at frameworks for openness which will involve us investigating agile methodologies, decentralisation, and using open principles in practice!

Do you want to have a chat about how some of these examples might be tailored for your organisation? [Get in touch](#) to see how we can help!



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3. Open & agile

Email subject: 🔒 Where agile meets open

👋 Hello again!

So far in *What We Talk About When We Talk About Open*, an email course from We Are Open Co-op, we've examined what openness means and checked out what it looks like in practice. This time, we're looking at the overlap between openness and 'agile' methodologies and working openly.

If you've had this email forwarded to you from a friend or colleague, you can sign up for yourself [here](#).

Benefits of Open

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greater
AGILITY



faster
INNOVATION



increased
ENGAGEMENT

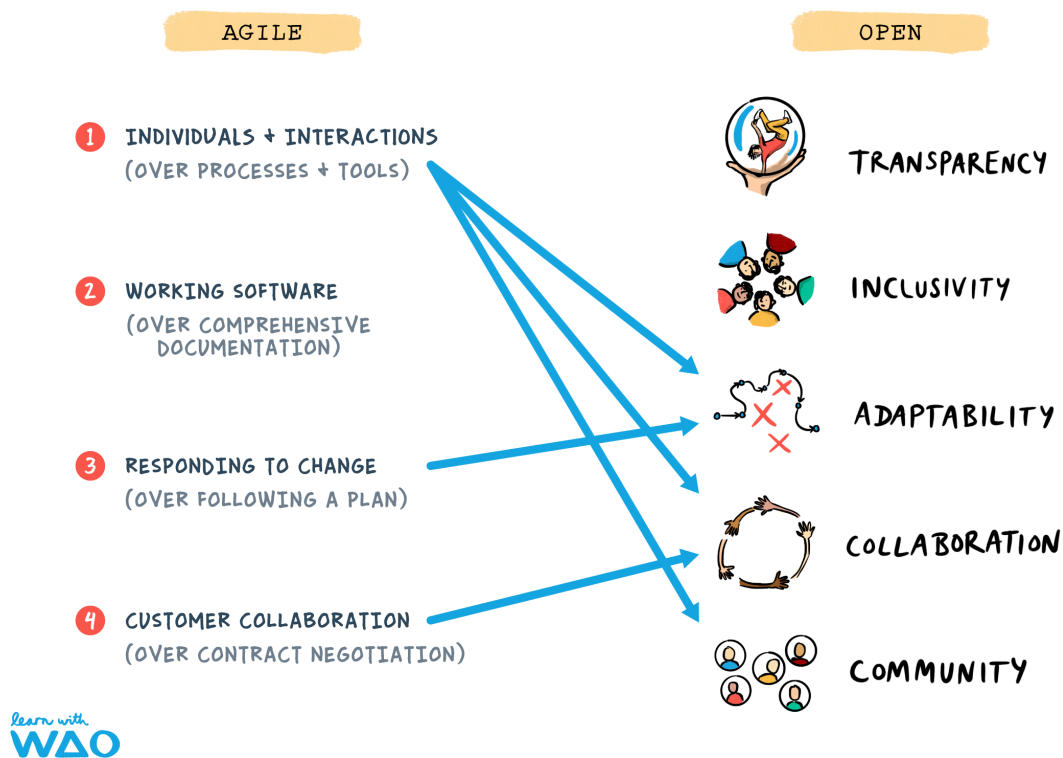
As we've repeated many times so far, the three main benefits of working openly are **greater agility**, **faster innovation**, and **increased engagement**. You might have heard these advantages, and especially the first two, being used to promote agile methodologies? So let's look at the relationship between open and agile.

When we talk about agile methodologies, we're borrowing a term from software development and, in particular, from the [Manifesto for Agile Software Development](#). You may have heard people talk about 'agile' but not really know what they mean. Here are the characteristics of an agile project:

1. **Individuals and interactions** over processes and tools

2. **Working software** over comprehensive documentation
3. **Customer collaboration** over contract negotiation
4. **Responding to change** over following a plan

These are quite similar to the characteristics of open organisations that we discovered in the first email of this course. Working openly and agile working are not *exactly* the same, of course, but there's significant overlap:



In addition to this overlap between open and agile, open organisations are particularly focused on **transparency** and **inclusivity**. Why do open advocates care about transparency and inclusivity specifically? Because as technology becomes ubiquitous, we know that we are *safer* when we can look under the hood, and we know that our safety is contingent on the safety of others.

It's not either/or! In fact, being agile *and* open is the best of both worlds. Here's a summary of how open and agile can work well together:

Agile	Open
- Regular check-in calls, (sometimes called 'stand-ups') - User stories - Iterative development - Retrospectives - Timeboxing	- Transparent decision-making - Public and explicit goals - Welcome diverse contribution - Provide accessible feedback mechanisms - Statement on core values

Working in an agile, open way is all about being transparent, adaptable, valuing individuals, and responding to change.

Empowering others to make decisions towards an agreed goal is one of the most powerful things you can do within any kind of organisation. The easiest way to do that is to reduce bureaucracy and allow those closest to the issue to make decisions. Doing this reduces the overall number of meetings required, saves time, and *increases* the engagement of members within your organisation!

Let's get practical! Choose one of the three approaches listed below and try them out in your organisation *this week*.

1. **User stories** — who is your organisation trying to help or impact? have you stepped into their shoes or [defined the cast](#)? do you have defined user stories and [personas](#) to help empower the members of your organisation without having to continually check with their boss (and their boss's boss)
2. **Timeboxing** — does your organisation tend to fix the scope of what you are trying to get done in advance? have you tried setting the *amount of time* you want to spend working towards a goal? have you tried [timeboxing](#) instead of scopeboxing?
3. **Retrospectives** — when your team or organisation finishes a project, does it hold a meeting to go through lessons learned? do you hold regular [retrospectives](#) to ensure successes can be replicated in future projects (and failures averted)?

Next up: we'll be looking at open behaviours which will involve us checking out everything from open licensing to leading open innovation by example!

Do you need more help working in a more agile and open way? Is your organisation quite... complicated? We Are Open's experts are ready to help you untangle and streamline your processes and procedures. [Get in touch](#) to find out more!



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4. Open behaviours

Email subject: 🔒 Open behaviours

👋 Hello!

You're in the safe hands of We Are Open Co-op, bringing you another instalment of *What We Talk About When We Talk About Open*. We're helping you understand and implement open practices, and so far have covered with you: what openness means, some examples of open practices, and the synergy between working open and agile methodologies.

Has this email been forwarded to you by a friend or colleague? You can sign up for yourself [here!](#)



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One of the advantages of working openly is that you become what we call “comfortable in chaos”. Not that we want *full* chaos to be unleashed, of course, but openness can be, well...

delightfully unpredictable sometimes. That's because to work openly is a very *human* approach.

Before we dig into that further, let's remind ourselves of those three benefits of open:

- **Greater agility** — members are more capable of working toward goals in unison and with shared vision;
- **Faster innovation** — ideas from both inside and outside the organisation receive more equitable consideration and rapid experimentation, and;
- **Increased engagement** — members clearly see connections between their particular activities and an organization's overarching values, mission, and spirit.

So why isn't everyone working openly? After all, who *doesn't* want all that agility, innovation and engagement!? Everyone **says** they want those things for their businesses, organisations and teams, but we're going to let you in on a few things that might help...



Open behaviours are mostly about stuff going on INSIDE HUMAN BRAINS

You can't see, feel, or touch openness. It's like the wind: you can only see its impact and effects. As we said early on in this course, **open is an attitude** which means, well, *some people might not like what they see*. If openness is something new to them, it can be seen as a threat.

There is a whole world of research and information out there about this, but we should probably touch on **unconscious bias**. This is a brain mechanism that simplifies information so you can use past experiences and knowledge to make decisions or take action more quickly. It's not always bad!

We make judgements based on things that are *not related* to the current person, situation or thing - for example making assumptions about how good someone will be at something because of the way they dress. Being aware of unconscious bias is key to understanding why and how we react and perceive our surroundings.

Openness improves **human connection**. It gives us agency, which in turn helps with our physical and mental wellbeing. Then, to close the loop of this virtuous circle, our wellbeing has a positive effect on our efficiency and productivity at work!

"I define connection as the energy that exists between people when they feel seen, heard, and valued; when they can give and receive without judgment; and when they derive sustenance and strength from the relationship." (Brené Brown)

The way we act in shared spaces changes the fabric of those spaces. The way we interact and share changes the way others interact and share with us. Remembering this will help you lead open innovation in your organisation.



Being a Leader depends on a kind of ‘minimum viable bureaucracy’

Displaying open behaviours as a leader is about generating **trust through transparency**. This trust takes two forms:

- Begging by trusting others
- Be trustworthy

As leaders, it's possible to weigh people down with policies and procedures, getting them to 'jump through hoops' which stand between them and the important work they need to be getting on with doing.

Instead, the open leader trusts the people they're working with and is themselves reliable. For example, they ensure that they and others don't commit to things that can't be achieved in a given time period, and show up (and on time!) for colleagues.

Fundamentally, open behaviours are about putting your ego to one side. Instead of having your 'ducks in a row', the idea is to instead encourage [self-organising ducks](#). This involves giving people enough autonomy, trust, and latitude to manage themselves.



Remix = rocket fuel!

You may have noticed at the bottom of each of our emails that We Are Open Co-op uses **open licensing** on everything we produce. Open licensing allows you to share your work and use that of others without having to be concerned about legal issues.

While there are *many* different licenses for all kinds of things from art to computer code, we often fall back on [Creative Commons licenses](#). Openly licensed materials means you don't have to keep reinventing the wheel every time you have a new idea, project or assignment.

Also, reusing and remixing the ideas of others is [how good ideas come about](#). It's how we make the world a better place. So if you've never looked into it, check out the activity below to learn more about open licensing.

Let's practice some open behaviours and get you seen through a simple but fun project that you can share with your colleagues and social networks!

Here's what to do:

1. [Remix the Top Trump card here](#). Be real and put down a few categories and scores on how you see yourself.
2. Share your card with your colleagues, friends and/or on social media. If you use Twitter, tag us @WeAreOpenCoop – we'd LOVE to see what you made!
3. Ask for feedback and see what people say. Do others reciprocate?

Next up: we'll be looking at tools and processes for working openly, making a distinction between open source software and open culture, and talking about working 'open by default'.

We Are Open runs in-depth courses on openness that you, your team, and your organisation can access. [Get in touch](#) to find out more!



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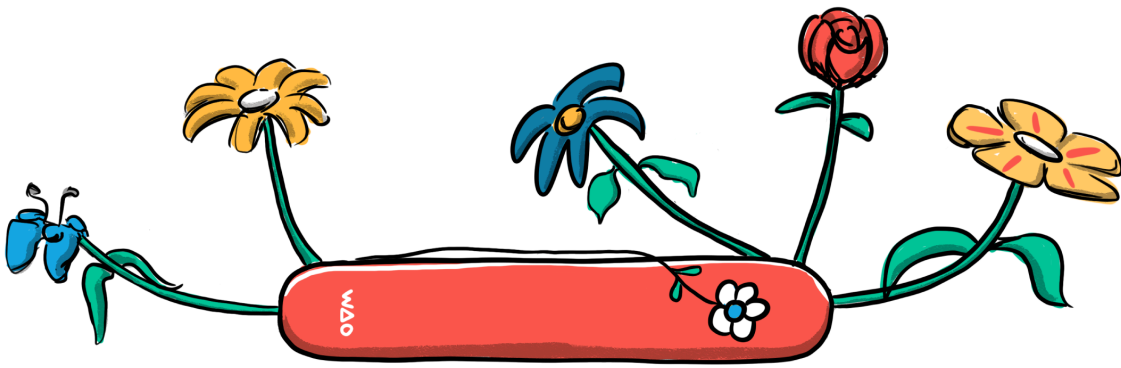
5. Tools of openness

Email subject:  Tools of openness

 Hello again!

In the course so far we've covered everything from open behaviours to agile methodologies, from definitions of 'open' to examples of open working in practice. The aim is to help you level up your open game, ready to be a changemaker in *your* organisation.

If this email has been forwarded to you by a friend or colleague then we really would recommend you signing up for yourself [here](#) to get the full experience!



SAME PROBLEMS – *different tools*

Sometimes, when we mention the name of our co-op ('We Are Open') people assume that we focus on [Open Source Software](#):

"Open-source software (OSS) is a type of computer software in which source code is released under a license in which the copyright holder grants users the rights to use, study, change, and distribute the software to anyone and for any purpose." (Wikipedia)

Don't worry, we're not going to go into lots of technical stuff in this part of the course. We just wanted to point out that while we think OSS is great, the kind of 'openness' we're focusing on here is slightly different. We're talking about **open culture**.

Benefits of Open

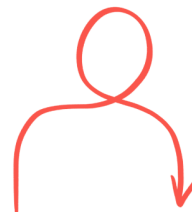
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greater
AGILITY



faster
INNOVATION



increased
ENGAGEMENT

Open culture takes its cues from the way that OSS projects work. By focusing on the **values** that people have in common these projects are often so attractive that people willingly volunteer their time. This kind of approach is extremely powerful and we've found it can be replicated whether or not the end product is software.

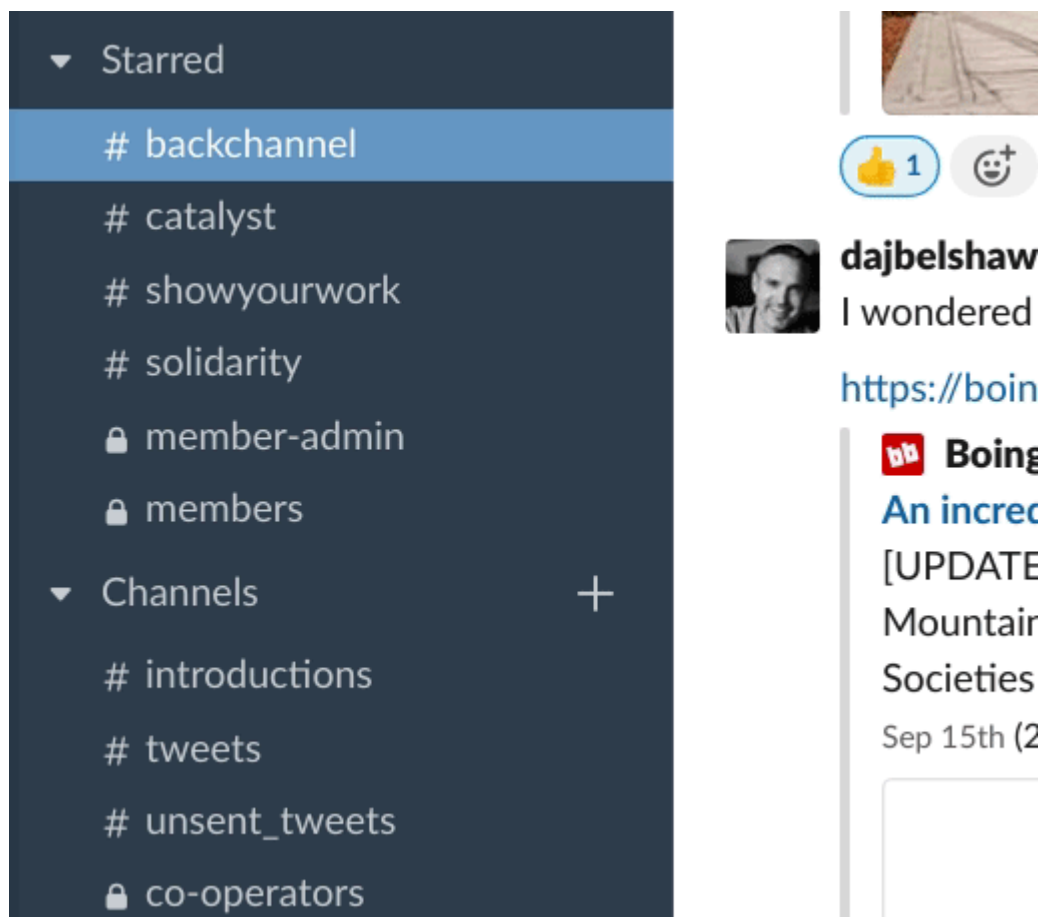
Even people who are motivated to work with one another still need organising and to put in place processes. So here are some open culture tools and techniques that might help you and your organisation.

Greater agility

Members are more capable of working toward goals in unison and with shared vision

Like many organisations, We Are Open uses a ‘workplace chat’ platform rather than spending our days emailing one another. In our case, it’s [Slack](#), but there are many other, possibly, better options!

Even with a small co-op, when everyone’s busy, chatting, and working openly it can get, well, **noisy**. In some organisations that means people retreating to private channels to control this, but we try to keep everything open. After all, as media theorist Clay Shirky famously said, “*it’s not information overload, it’s filter failure*”.



Platforms like Slack have features that allow you to control, among other things:

- **Who** gets notified about an update
- **When** people can be disturbed by notifications
- **Where** people get updates (i.e. from which channels)

Just as we shouldn't assume people know how to use email well, we shouldn't automatically assume that everyone knows how to use workplace chat apps effectively. So instead of colleagues scurrying off to private channels to avoid notification overload, perhaps have a conversation about organisational use of these kinds of apps?

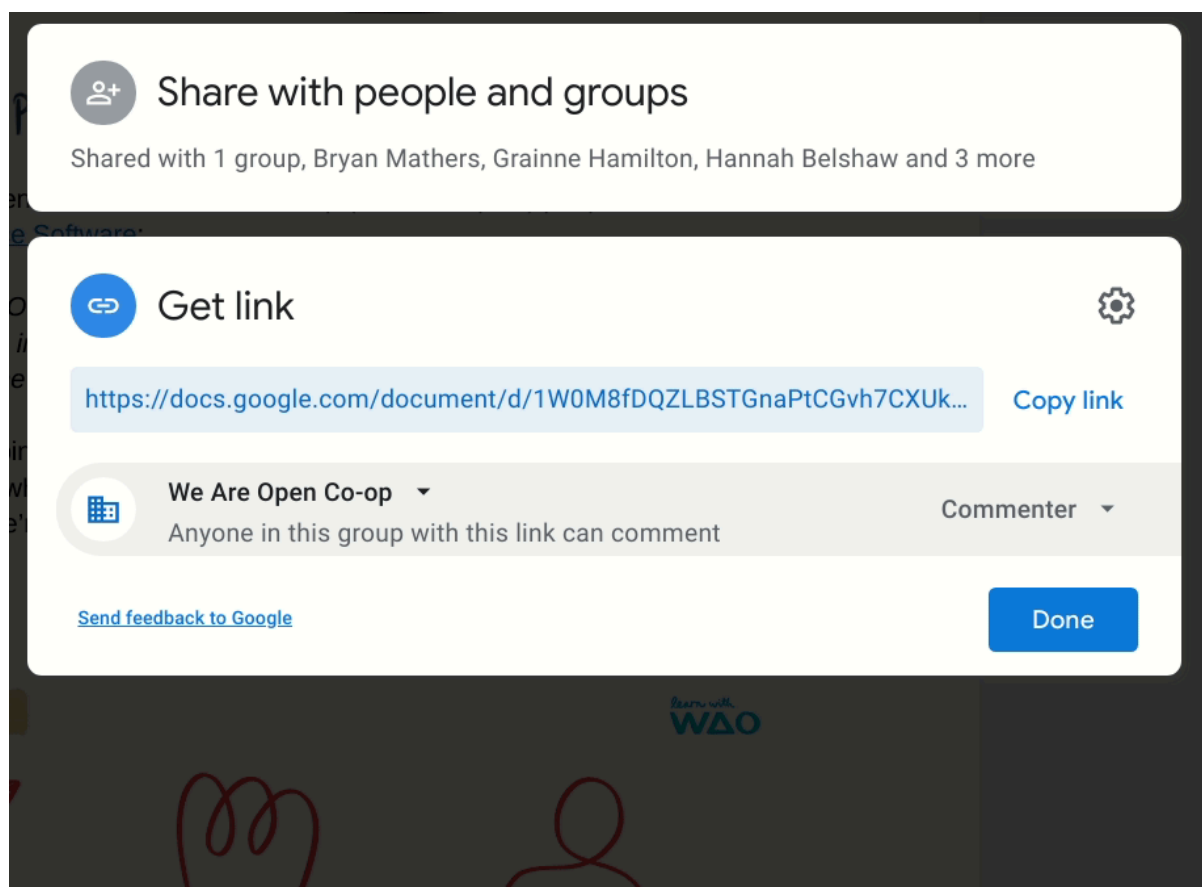
Top tips

- **Start with small adjustments in your information flow** - for example, make sure each team has their own chat channel, and add complexity when it's necessary.
- **Have regular conversations about your tooling and processes** - the best people to give organisational feedback on tools and processes are those who use them every day. You can keep track of your processes to help new starters and to solve any disputes, which is why we love [our wiki](#).

Faster innovation

Ideas from both inside and outside the organisation receive more equitable consideration and rapid experimentation

One easy way into thinking about the tools we use to work openly is by thinking about the options that Google gives for sharing Docs or YouTube videos. You may be familiar with something like this:



It's tempting to think of these as 'openness' settings, but in actual fact they give only quite simple controls over who can *access* documents, videos, etc. Our co-op encourages organisations to make work available to the *widest* number of people possible, and then restrict it as necessary. It's been claimed that knowledge workers sometimes spend up to 40% of their week just trying to find the information they need to do their job.

Just to clarify, working openly doesn't **necessarily** mean working *publicly*. Remember, open is not a binary, it's a continuum. You can work openly within your organisation so long as everyone has access to the relevant information.

Top tips

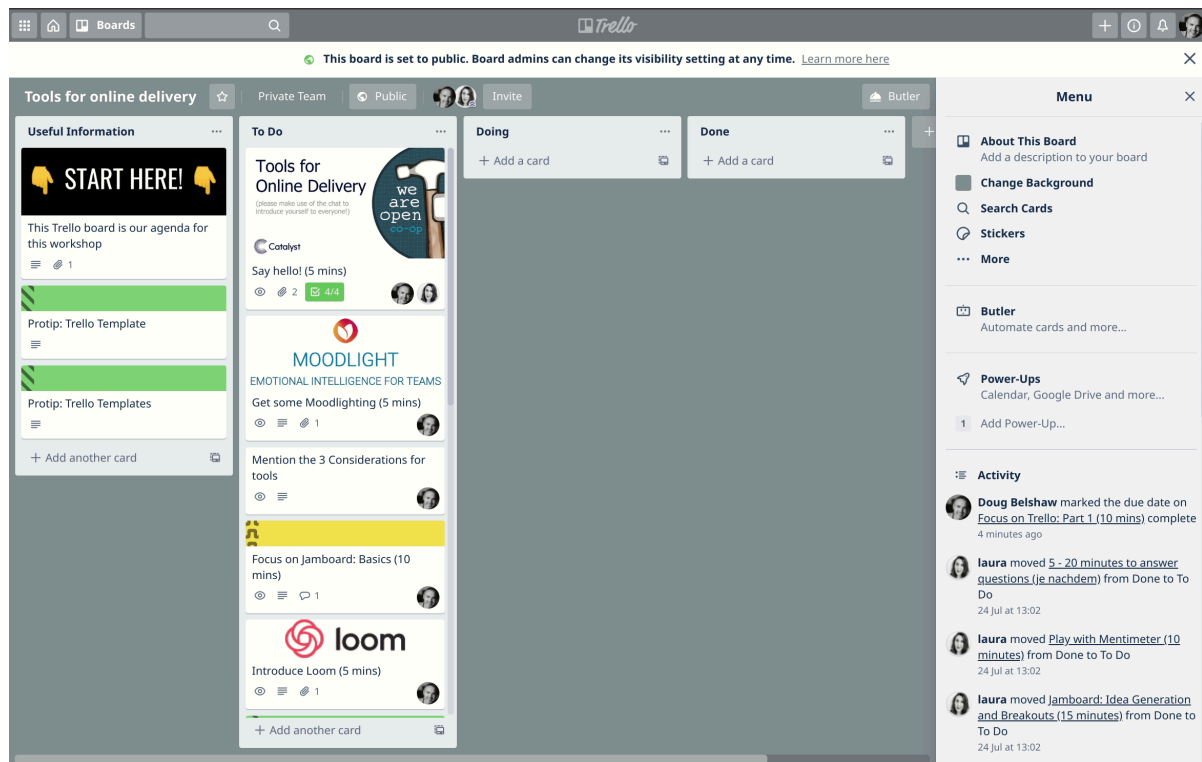
- **Ensure that people have access** - this is the first step to making sure that people can jumpstart innovation. Afterall, if they have access, they can gain context.
- **Schedule regular check-ins and context-setting chats** - structured meetings that reference new and existing documents will help keep you and your colleagues on the same page.

Increased engagement

Members clearly see connections between their particular activities and an organization's overarching values, mission, and spirit

Working openly is more than theoretically giving people access to something. It's about the process of sharing and **notifying** them. Tools that are good for working openly are therefore those where everyone who *should* be able to see what's going on *can* see what is going on, and can be notified about any updates/changes.

Let's use a concrete example using one of our co-op's favourite tools: [Trello](#). Now you might prefer a different kanban-style tool for tracking what is 'To Do', 'Doing', and 'Done' but for the sake of argument let's use this one from a recent workshop we ran. Notice what happens in the **Activity** section on the right-hand side when I move a card from 'To Do' to 'Doing':



Top tips

- **Repetition and structure is useful** - it can be helpful for both engagement and efficiency.
- **Minimise cognitive load** - although not every project is the same, find ways to use templates and formatting so that colleagues can easily duplicate, copy and paste.

Let's practice some open behaviours by changing the way we use tools in open ways.

Here's some practical suggestions:

1. **Control** your notification settings if your workplace chat app so that you can safely ignore things that don't immediately concern you and focus on those things where you can help.
2. **Share** documents in the most open way possible — that might mean publicly on the web, or it might mean so that everyone in your organisation can see.
3. **Organise** your work using a platform or tool where others can see what you're up to — not so they can *track* you, but so they can help/advise in timely ways!
4. **Communicate** with your peers and talk about the processes and structures you're using to work together.

Next up: we'll be looking at community building strategy and tactics which will see us cover architectures of participation, personas, and minimum viable communities.

We Are Open can advise you on specific tools and processes for your organisation. [Get in touch](#) to find out how we can help!



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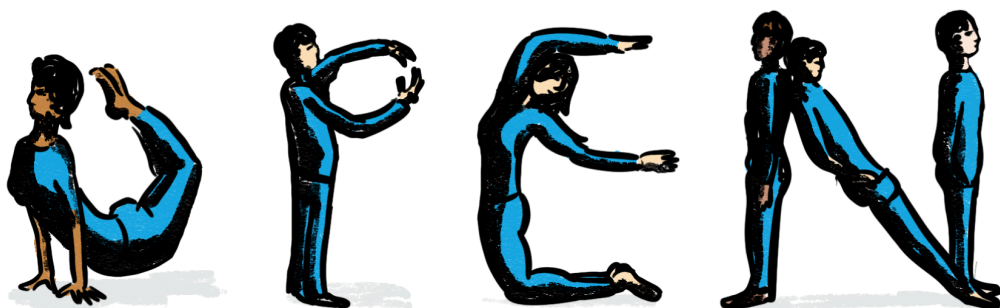
6. Community building strategy & tactics

Email subject:  Community building strategy & tactics

 Hello again!

You're tuned into *What We Talk About When We Talk About Open* from [We Are Open Co-op](#). Thus far we've discussed what we mean by openness, shared some examples of open practices, made links between open and agile practices, given an insight into what open leadership behaviours look like, and pointed you towards some useful tools for open working.

If this email has been forwarded to you by a friend or colleague, you might want to sign up for yourself [here](#) so you can start from the beginning!



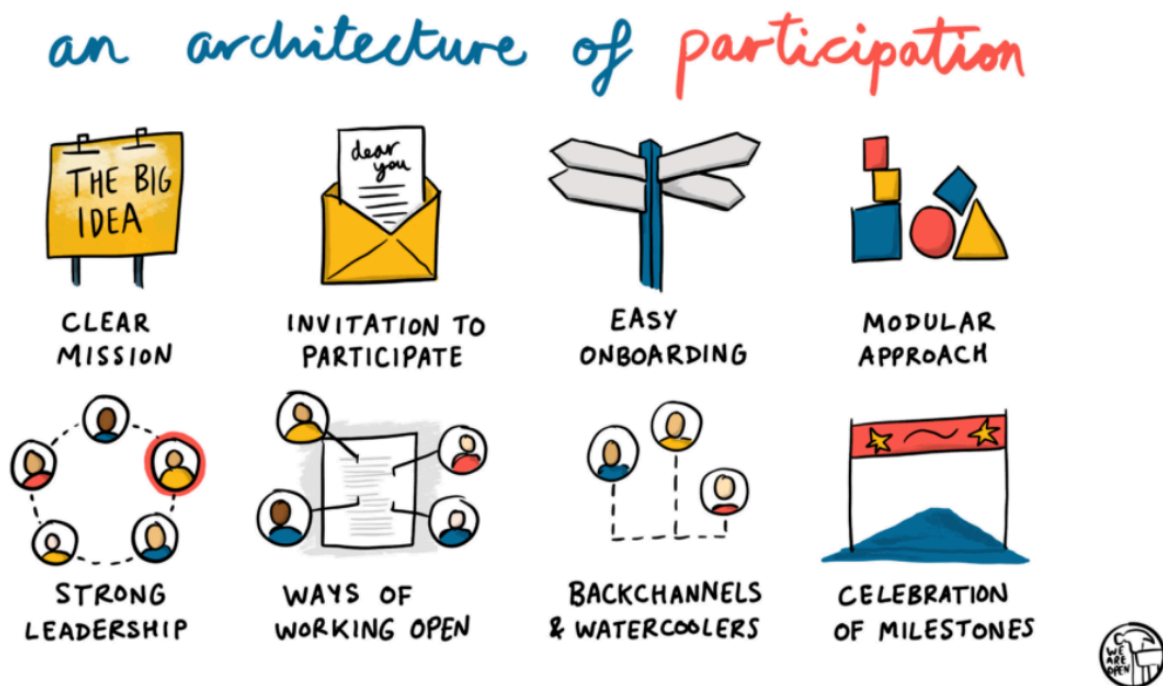
WAO

Throughout this course, we've been introducing you to some of the theoretical underpinnings that are fundamental to working openly. Now we're moving onto community building

strategies and tactics, which is not only thinking about open source projects, but also the community *inside* your organisation. How can they participate?

First things first, let's make no mistake, community building is *hard*. It's hard because every community is different, and we are interested in healthy, diverse communities. Healthy communities we define as those that have a clear focus on giving people *connection* and *agency*.

It can be easier than you think, however, to empower people and give them agency. You simply say "*What do you think?*" or send a short email that offers a human connection. "*Hey! Thanks for showing up.*" It might seem simple, but it sets your community up for success. It's worth being intentional about this, and one approach to ensure you have covered all the bases is to think about creating an 'architecture of participation'.



The phrase "architecture of participation" comes from web publisher, entrepreneur Tim O'Reilly. He used it to describe the nature of systems that are designed for user contribution, such as Open Source Software, wiki platforms, and other collaborative authoring tools.

Organisations such as Greenpeace, Mozilla, and others with a global mission rely on volunteers and systems to achieve their goals. Ensuring a strong architecture of participation is therefore crucial to achieve this. An architecture of participation will help you achieve your goals too, regardless of which context you're working in.

- [**Architecture of Participation**](#) - once you know who your community is made up of, figure out how you can help them achieve what they want!

- [Minimum Viable Community](#) - the community canvas work helps you identify and build meaningful community relationships.
- [Personas](#) - stand in the shoes of the people you are trying to engage with as, regardless of the type of community you're building, identifying people's wants and will help.

Starting with the approaches above will give you a really good start in capturing the main benefits of openness, **greater agility**, **faster innovation**, and **increased engagement**!

Let's think about what the architecture of participation looks like for your organisation!

1. Could you *draw* your organisation's current architecture of participation?
 2. Now draw the architecture of participation for an organisation that you've volunteered with in the past?
 3. What are the differences between them? Which of the eight elements of a strong architecture of participation are present or missing in each case?
-

Next up: we'll be wrapping up this introductory course on openness and giving you some next steps for your open journey!

Do you feel like your context is entirely too complicated for this? We Are Open works with organisations big and small to help them jumpstart innovation, resilience and community initiatives. [Get in touch](#) to find out more!



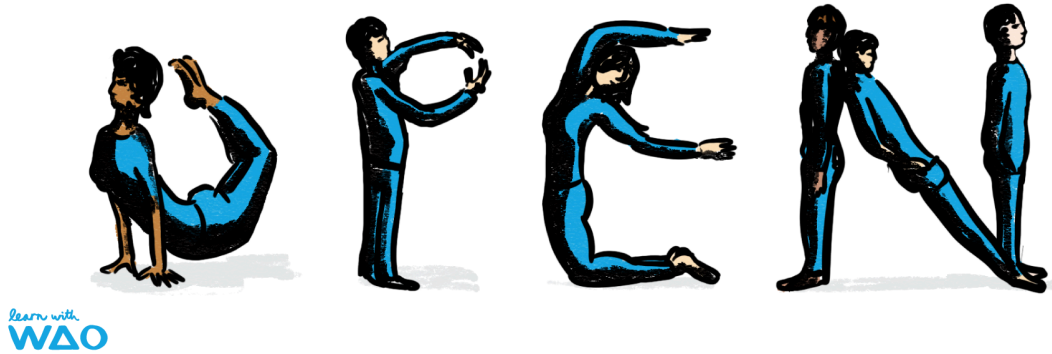
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7. Conclusion

Email subject:  Conclusion: bringing it all together (and next steps...)

what we talk about

WHEN WE TALK ABOUT



👋 Hello!

Thanks for joining us for this introductory course from We Are Open Co-op! We've covered a **bunch** of things over the last couple of weeks, so you might want to revisit previous emails to recap just *some* of the following:

- The benefits of working openly
- Creative Commons licenses
- The interaction between agile and open practices
- Minimum Viable Bureaucracy
- Architectures of participation

We can only make this course better based on what you tell us, so would you consider spending five minutes giving us some brief feedback? Thanks in advance!

How likely is it that you would recommend this course to a friend or colleague?

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Not at all likely

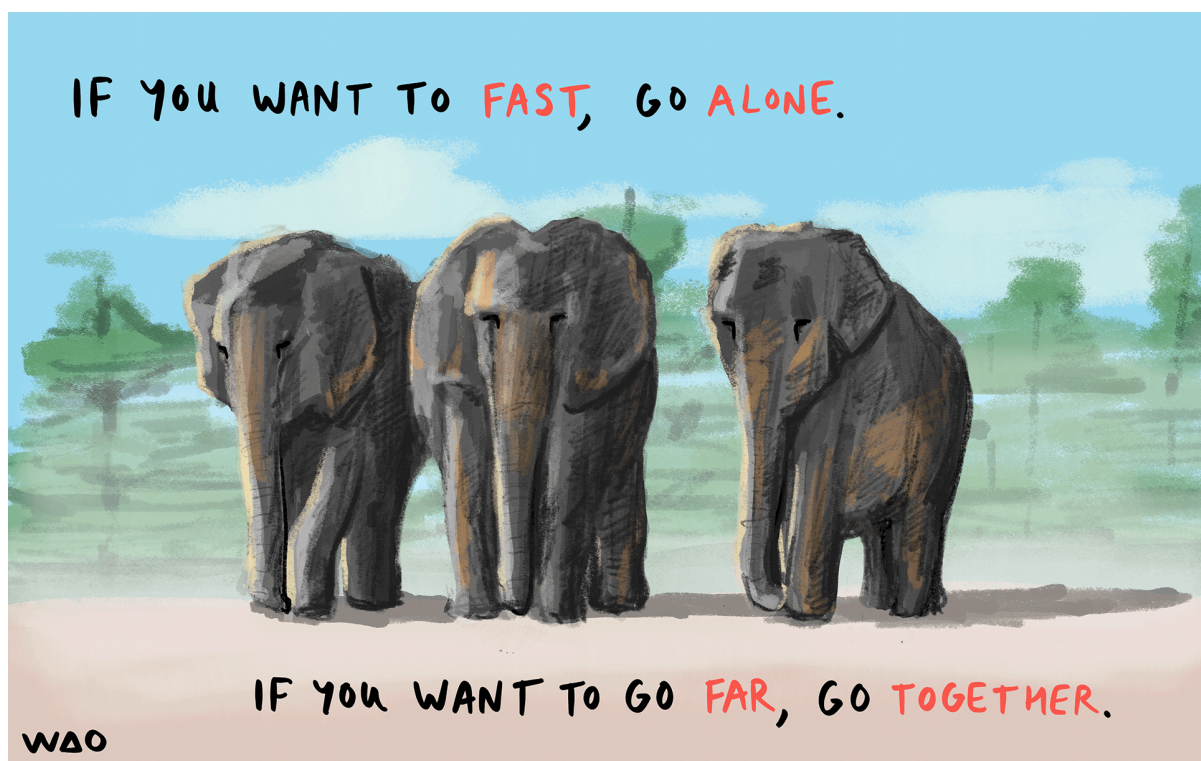
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Extremely likely

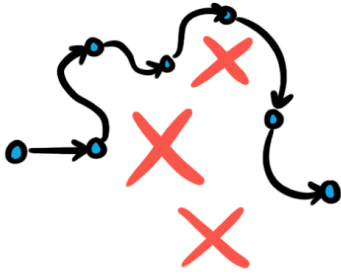
If this has whetted your appetite and you want to learn more about openness in practice, then we suggest you **get in touch** with us either by just hitting reply to this email, or via the contact form on our website: <https://weareopen.coop/contact>

If this has whetted your appetite and you want to learn more about openness in practice, then we suggest you get to know our members. Some of us are founding members of [the Open Organization](#), some of us are the brains behind Open Badges...We've been spreading open culture in organizations big and small for decades. How can we help YOUR team open up?

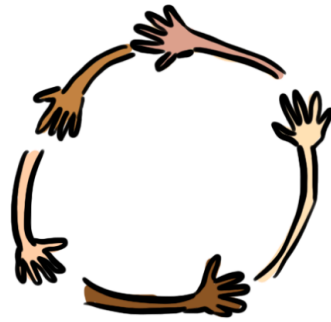
Finally, could you share this course with others who might benefit from it? Just send them to the following link for them to be able to sign up for themselves:
<https://learnwith.weareopen.coop/open-course>



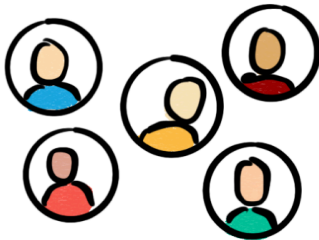
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ADAPTABILITY



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COMMUNITY



TRANSPARENCY



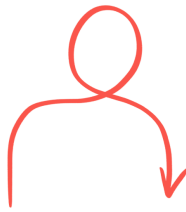
INCLUSIVITY



faster
INNOVATION



greater
AGILITY



increased
ENGAGEMENT



WAO